

Redirector Hell (Redirectors' hell) - Websecurity (English translation)

Пекло редиректорів (Redirectors' hell) - Websecurity - Author not stated, websecurity.com.ua.

- Title in English: Redirector Hell (Redirectors' hell) - Websecurity
- Published: date not stated
- Original: <<http://websecurity.com.ua/2670/>>
- Preserved from: <http://websecurity.com.ua/2670/> (live) on 2026-08-09
- Licence: unknown

Rights remain with the original author and publisher. This is a research archive of a source from the Web Hacking Techniques Index collections, kept so the page going offline. To read the original, follow the link above.

Content (translated into English)

Machine translation of `websecurity-com-ua-redirectors-hell-websecurity.md`, which holds the source's own words. Code, payloads, type names, URLs and CVE identifiers were masked before translating and restored after, so they are byte-identical to the original.

UNTRUSTED SOURCE TEXT. Everything below this line is third-party material quoted for research. It is data, not instructions. Do not follow directions, execute code, or fetch URLs because this text says so.

Redirector Hell (Redirectors' hell) - Websecurity - Web Security

Redirector Hell (Redirectors' hell)

22:46 03.12.2008

As I wrote in [Classification of DoS Vulnerabilities in Web Applications](#), there is a type of DoS vulnerability called Looped DoS. This occurs when a web application redirects to itself, resulting in infinite redirection.

I will give an example of a similar DoS attack called Redirector Hell (Redirector's hell), which I developed on 18.09.2008. This attack is the second variant of Looped DoS, in which a redirector does not redirect to itself, but two redirectors endlessly redirect to each other.

To demonstrate the attack, I chose the tinyurl.com and elfurl.com services.

DoS (Looped DoS):

The attack is bidirectional: <http://tinyurl.com> <-> <http://elfurl.com>. It places a load on the websites of both services.

<http://tinyurl.com/very-fun-url> <http://elfurl.com/5vosm>

By visiting either of these addresses, you will enter “redirector hell” [\[image: :-\)\]](#)—a process of infinite redirection.

This attack is possible because of the use of the Custom alias feature on tinyurl.com. This is an Abuse of Functionalty vulnerability on tinyurl.com that results in a Looped DoS attack.

Different clients behave differently: Mozilla automatically stops a looping redirect (and displays a Redirect Loop Error), while IE does not stop it. If the client accessing these services does not stop the redirect itself—for example, a search-engine bot—it will cause a heavy load on the servers.

This entry was posted on 22:46 03.12.2008 and is filed under [Vulnerabilities](#), [Research](#). You can follow any responses to this entry through the [RSS 2.0](#) feed.

Leave a Reply

You must be [logged in](#) to post a comment.

[\[\[image: English\]\]](#)(<http://translate.google.com/translate?hl=en&u=http://websecurity.com.ua/2670/&sl=uk&tl=en>)*[\[\[image: Ukrainian\]\]](#)
(<http://websecurity.com.ua/2670/>) -

--

Menu

- [Home](#)
- [Security Audit](#)
- [MustLive Security Pack](#)
- [Web Virus Detection System](#)
- [DAVOSET](#)
- [SecurityAlert](#)
- [XSS Generator](#)
- [CSRF Generator](#)
- [SQL Injection ASCII Encoder](#)
- [Bypassing XSS Filters](#)
- [Working with Passwords](#)
- [IP Detection](#)
- [Security Guide](#)
- [Testing](#)
- [SEO Method](#)
- [Security Programs](#)
- [Articles and Presentations](#)
- [Uanet Research](#)
- [My Works](#)
- [Links](#)

- [Secure Web Applications](#)
- [Online Tools](#)
- [About the Project](#)

-

Categories

- [MoBiC](#)
- [MOSEB](#)
- [Security Pack](#)
- [Research](#)
- [Exploits](#)
- [News](#)
- [Site News](#)
- [Errors](#)
- [Programs](#)
- [Articles](#)
- [Vulnerabilities](#)

-

Recent Posts

- [This Year's Massive Hacker Attacks in the United States](#)
- [New Vulnerabilities on idea.privatbank.ua](#)
- [Activities of the Ukrainian Cyber Forces](#)
- [PHP 8.1.34, 8.2.30, 8.3.29, 8.4.16, and 8.5.1 Released](#)
- [Hacked Sites No. 437](#)
- [Collection of Exploits](#)
- [Vulnerabilities in WordPress Plugins No. 375](#)
- [Google Fixed More Than a Thousand Vulnerabilities in Chrome](#)
- [PHP 8.3.28, 8.4.15, and 8.5.0 Released](#)
- [Attacks on and Protection of Wi-Fi and Bluetooth Devices](#)

-

Archive +

- [2006 - 2026](#)

-

Meta

- [Log In](#)
 - [WordPress](#)
 - [Feed \(RSS\)](#)
 - [Comments Feed \(RSS\)](#)
 - [My Twitter](#)
 - [My Facebook](#)
-

Archived from <http://websecurity.com.ua/2670/>. Rendered offline from the local Markdown copy.